

Dr. Max Heermann

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Current Positions

since 01.2025: Postdoctoral Researcher, ETH Zürich

Research Group on Multilevel Politics

Project: *Public Reinsurance in Multilevel Politics (EUROPE RE)*

since 01.2025: Associated Researcher, University of Konstanz

Cluster of Excellence: The Politics of Inequality

Project: *Conditions of International Solidarity (CONSOLI)*

Previous Positions

04.2024 - 12.2024: Postdoctoral Researcher, University of Konstanz

Cluster of Excellence: The Politics of Inequality

Project: *Conditions of International Solidarity (CONSOLI)*

10.2022 - 03.2024: Predoctoral Researcher, University of Konstanz

Cluster of Excellence: The Politics of Inequality

Project: *Conditions of International Solidarity (CONSOLI)*

10.2016 - 09.2022: Predoctoral Researcher, University of Konstanz

Research Group for International Politics

Project: *EU3D - Differentiation, Dominance and Democracy (10/2020-09/2022)*

Education

10.2016 - 03.2024: Ph.D. in Political Science, University of Konstanz

Thesis: *Preferences and Coalitions in European Union Internet Policy*

Committee: Dirk Leuffen, Gerald Schneider, Andreas Jungherr

09.2015 - 07.2016: M.Sc. in European Governance, Utrecht University

Double degree programme with the University of Konstanz

10.2014 - 09.2016: M.A. in Politics and Public Administration, University of Konstanz

Track: Comparative Politics and Public Policy Analysis

Double degree programme with Utrecht University

10.2011 - 09.2014: B.A. in Politics and Public Administration, University of Konstanz
Semester abroad: Jagiellonian Universität Kraków (09/2013-02/2014)

Academic Publications

Peer-Reviewed Journal Articles.....

Heermann, M., Baute, S., & Leuffen, D. (2025). Democratic Backsliding and Support for Public Good Provision in the European Union. *Journal of European Public Policy*, 1–29. <https://doi.org/10.1080/13501763.2025.2503973>

Steinecke, D., & Heermann, M. (2024). West Lothians in the European Parliament? Diverging Vote Choices in Cases of Differentiated Integration *Swiss Political Science Review*, 30(4), 472-485. <https://doi.org/10.1111/spsr.12631>

Heermann, M., Leuffen, D., & Schuessler, J. (2024). Differentiation, Dominance and Fairness in the European Union: Bringing in the Citizens' Perspective. *European Journal of Political Research*, 63(4), 1622-1641. <https://doi.org/10.1111/1475-6765.12672>

De Blok, L., Heermann, M., Schuessler, J., De Vries, C. E., & Leuffen, D. (2024). All on Board? The Role of Institutional Design for Public Support for Differentiated Integration *European Union Politics*, 25(3), 593-604.
<https://doi.org/10.1177/14651165241246384>

Heermann, M. (2024). Undermining Lobbying Coalitions: The Interest Group Politics of EU Copyright Reform. *Journal of European Public Policy*, 31(8), 2287-2315. <https://doi.org/10.1080/13501763.2023.2249948>

Heermann, M. (2024). Civil Liberties or Economic Freedom? The Political Space of Internet Policy in the European Parliament, 1999-2014. *Journal of European Public Policy*, 31(5), 1368-1395. <https://doi.org/10.1080/13501763.2023.2175019>

Heermann, M., Leuffen, D., Tigges, F. (2024). Change to Stay the Same? German European Preference Formation During the COVID-19 Crisis. *German Politics*, 33(2), 411-433. <https://doi.org/10.1080/09644008.2023.2189701>

Heermann, M., Koos, S. & Leuffen, D. (2023). Who Deserves European Solidarity? How Recipient Characteristics Shape Public Support for International Medical and Financial Aid during COVID-19. *British Journal of Political Science*, 53(2), 629-651. <https://doi.org/10.1017/S0007123422000357>

Leuffen, D., Mounchid, P., Heermann, M., & Koos, S. (2023). Mobilizing Domestic Support for International Vaccine Solidarity: Recommendations for Health Crisis Communication. *npj Vaccines*, 8(28). <https://doi.org/10.1038/s41541-023-00625-x>

Schuessler, J., Heermann, M., Leuffen, D., De Blok, L., & De Vries, C. E. (2023). Mapping Public Support for the Varieties of Differentiated Integration. *European Union Politics*, 24(1), 164–183. <https://doi.org/10.1177/14651165221127633>

Heermann, M. & Leuffen, D. (2020.) No Representation without Integration! Why Differentiated Integration Challenges the Composition of the European Parliament. *JCMS: Journal of Common Market Studies* 58(4): 1016-1033. <https://doi.org/10.1111/jcms.13015>

Chapters in Edited Volumes.....

Heermann, M. & Tigges, F. (2025). The German Debate on the Future of Europe at the End of the Merkel Era: Governmental Pragmatism and Visions from the Opposition?. In: Góra, M., Thevenin, E., & Zielińska, K. (eds.) *Political Actors' Narratives on the Reforms of the European Union: Future Visions of Europe?* London: Routledge. <https://doi.org/10.4324/9781003589044>

Heermann, M., & Leuffen, D. (2024). No Solidarity without Norm Conformity: Democratic Backsliding Reduces Solidarity and Increases the Desire for Punishment amongst EU Citizens. In: Batora, J., & Fossum, J.E. (eds). *Differentiation and Dominance in Europe's Poly-Crises*. London: Routledge. <https://doi.org/10.4324/9781003291190-15>

Heermann, M., Leuffen, D., Tigges, F., & Mounchid, P. (2022). Nur wer sich ändert, bleibt sich treu? Die Europapolitik der Regierung Merkel IV. In: Zohlnhöfer, R., Engler, F. (eds.) *Das Ende der Merkel-Jahre*. Wiesbaden: Springer VS. https://doi.org/10.1007/978-3-658-38002-1_18

Work in Progress

Working Papers.....

Pasquettaz, G., Heermann, M. & Leuffen, D. Wither Multilateral Aid? The Mainstreaming of Populist Rhetoric and Public Support for International Solidarity. (*under review at Journal of European Public Policy*)

Heermann, M., Baute, S. & Leuffen, D. Public Support for the Waiver of Medical Patents: Evidence from an International Survey. (*under review at Acta Politica*)

Heermann, M. Of Activists and Platforms: Digital Rights Activism, Business Power and Political Alignments in the Digital Economy. (*Annual Best Paper Award 2024, Honorable Mention from the ECPR Standing Group on Interest Groups*)

Heermann, M. European Solidarity and Deservingness. (*Chapter for The Routledge Handbook of European Union Solidarity, eds. Ann-Kathrin Reinl & Francesco Nicoli. Forthcoming 2027*)

Heermann, M., Steinecke, D., & Leuffen, D. Compensation or Contagion? Public Support for International Cooperation after American Hegemony.

Baute, S., Heermann, M. & Leuffen, D. Building Global Communities of Fate: Citizens, Interdependence and Support for International Solidarity.

Baute, S., Heermann, M, Leuffen, D. & Pasquettaz, G. Mind the Populist Gap: How Multilateralists Can Defend Global Health Governance.

Work in Progress.....

For Domestic Consumption Only? How Leaders Adapt their Rhetoric to Domestic and International Audiences. (with *Quido Haskovec & Christian Freudlsperger*)

Public Preferences for National and International Risk Management. (with *Christian Freudlsperger & Elisa Paepcke* - pre-analysis plan available, pilot in progress)

Does Mainstream Party Conflict over European Integration Reduce Public Support for Eurosceptic Challenger Parties? (with *Christian Freudlsperger & Martin Weinrich*, pilot in progress)

Unpacking the Redistributive Chain in International Solidarity: A Vignette Experiment Across Four Democracies. (with *Sharon Baute & Dirk Leuffen* - pre-analysis plan available, data collection finished)

Rally around the Regulatory Polity? External Economic Threats and Public Support for EU Digital Policies (with *Philipp Bien & Lucas Schramm* - pre-analysis plan available, data collection finished)

The European Council – the EU’s Supreme Crisis Manager between Efficiency and Equality (with *Lucas Schramm & Thomas Bräuninger* - pre-analysis plan available, data collection finished)

Coming to the Rescue - How Exposure to Climate Change Risk Affects Support for International Cooperation in Europe (with *Lisanne de Blok, Catherine de Vries, Julian Schuessler & Dirk Leuffen* - pre-analysis plan available)

Outreach

Popular Writing & Policy Contributions.....

Maddah, M. & Heermann, M. World Leaders Use their First Foreign Trips to Signal Political Priorities. *ECPR The Loop*, 21.07.2025.

Leuffen, D., Baute, S., Heermann, M., Pasquettaz, G. Underestimated Solidarity. Public Support for Global Health Policies Is Stronger than Claimed. *In_Equality Magazine* No. 8, pp. 22-24, 07.2025.

Heermann, M. The Interest Group Politics of Online Content Regulation. *EUROPP: LSE European Politics and Policy Blog*, 29.08.2023.

Heermann, M. & Leuffen, D. To Differentiate or not to Differentiate: Public Opinion on Differentiated Integration in the European Union. *EU3D Policy Brief*, 30.03.2023.

Baute, S., Heermann, M. & Leuffen, D. European Solidarity and the Politics of Blame and Reciprocity. *Green European Journal*, 11.10.2022.

Heermann, M., Koos, S. & Leuffen, D. Weniger Rechtsstaat - weniger Hilfe: Die Erosion der Demokratie belastet die europäische Solidarität. *In_Equality Magazine* No. 3, pp. 48-51, 04.2022.

Heermann, M. Haftung oder Dezentralisierung? Der Digital Services Act und die Zukunft des Internets. *EURACTIV*, 23.10.2020.

Heermann, M. To Strengthen Democratic Legitimacy in a Differentiated EU, Turn to Transnational Lists. *Future of Europe Blog*, 18.09.2020.

Media Appearances.....

RBB Radio Eins. Wenn Demokratie bröckelt: EU-Bürger:innen setzen auf Sanktionen. *Die Profis*, 24.05.2025.

Teaching

ETH Zürich.....

2026: Political Behaviour in Europe's Multi-Level System, *MA research seminar*

2026: Contemporary European Politics, *lecture*

University of Konstanz.....

2020: Market Power Europe: Is the EU a Global Regulator?, *advanced undergraduate seminar*

2019: Supranationale Politik im Europäischen Parlament, *advanced undergraduate seminar*

2017: Supranationale Politik im Europäischen Parlament, *advanced undergraduate seminar*

2016: Das Europäische Parlament, *undergraduate seminar*

Salem Kolleg.....

2019: Internationale Politik, *seminar*

2018: Internationale Politik, *seminar*

Professional Activities

Organizer.....

University of Konstanz, 04/2019 - 12/2024: Co-organizer of a weekly ‘brown bag’ research colloquium for doctoral and postdoctoral researchers

Peer Reviewing.....

Acta Politica; Big Data & Society; Ecological Economics; European Journal of Political Research; European Political Science Review; European Union Politics; JCMS: Journal of Common Market Studies, Journal of European Public Policy; Publius: The Journal of Federalism; The Review of International Organizations; West European Politics.

Academic Conferences & Workshops.....

GEOTRADE Workshop on Contesting the Liberal International Order: Elites and Public Opinion, Salzburg, 2026 (convened by Andreas Dür); ECPR SG EU Conference, Catania, 2026; EPSS, Belfast, 2026; CES, Conference Dublin, 2026; ECPR Joint Sessions: Workshop on Global Governance in Times of Crises, Innsbruck, 2026; Workshop on the Politics of Pandemics & Health Governance, Leeds, 2026 (convened by Yoshiharu Kobayashi & Tobias Heinrich); Swiss Political Science Association Conference, Zürich, 2026; Italian Political Science Conference, Napoli, 2025; IPSA World Congress, Seoul, 2025; ECPR General Conference, Dublin, 2024; EPSA, Cologne, 2024; ECPR SG EU Conference, Lisbon, 2024; CES Conference, Reykjavík, 2023; DVPW Sektionstagung IB, Friedrichshafen, 2023; EU3D Concluding Conference, Kraków, 2023; Digital Democracy Workshop, Zürich, 2022; ECPR SG EU Conference, Rome, 2022; EUSA Conference, Miami, 2022; Digital Sovereignty Workshop Vienna, 2022 (convened by Gerda Falkner et al.); ECPR General Conference (online), 2021; ECPR SG Interest Groups Summer School (online), 2021; Digital Democracy Workshop, Zürich, 2020; ECPR SG Parliaments Workshop, Konstanz, 2019; Politicologenetmaal: Annual Political Science Workshops of the Low Countries, Antwerp, 2019

Invited Talks.....

12/2025: “Democratic Backsliding and Support for Public Good Provision in the European Union”, TRUEDEM Webinar Series organized by the ‘Trust in European Democracies’ Horizon Europe Consortium

01/2022: “Der Rechtsstaatlichkeits-Konflikt zwischen Polen und der Europäischen Union aus politikwissenschaftlicher Sicht”, European Law Students Association & Young European Federalists Konstanz

Languages & Skills

Languages: German (native), English (proficient), French (intermediate, B2)

Data Science: R, Stata

References

Dirk Leuffen

Professor of Political Science/International Politics
Department of Politics and Public Administration
University of Konstanz

Frank Schimmelfennig

Professor of European Politics
Department of Humanities, Social and Political Sciences
ETH Zürich

Christina Zuber

Professor of German Politics
Department of Politics and Public Administration
University of Konstanz

Sebastian Koos

Professor in Sociology with a Focus on Social Movements
Department of History and Sociology
University of Konstanz

Last updated: Zürich, 26 March 2026